

TEST

Questions Focusing on a Single Philosopher:

1. What does Socrates say is his mission in Athens?

Socrates says his mission in Athens is to make inquiry into the wisdom of anyone who appears to be wise, and to show them that they are not wise if they are not, in vindication of the oracle that he is the wisest. He is not content with his own wisdom, as he does not claim to be wise, but instead, he is on a divine mission to question and challenge the wisdom of others, which he does not do for his own interest or wealth, but as an obedient devotion to the god.

2. According to Epicurus, what is happiness?

According to Epicurus, happiness is the state of living a life free from pain and fear, which is attained by living wisely, honorably, and justly, and by understanding that the ultimate end of life is to be free from pain and fear. Epicurus also believes that happiness is reached by living a life that is in natural and necessary desires, and by maintaining a clear understanding of the nature of the gods, death, and the world. He also holds that friendship is the most important means to ensure happiness throughout life.

3. According to Augustine, where does moral evil come from?

According to Augustine, moral evil does not come from God, who is just and does not do evil. Evil of type (a), which is doing evil, is not the author of evil, but rather, evil of type (b), which is the evil suffered, is not the author of evil either, but rather, it is the author of evil that is not God. Augustine suggests that moral evil must come from a source other than God, as God is not the author of evil.

4. Why does Machiavelli think it is safer for a ruler to be feared than loved?

Machiavelli, in the provided context, states that it is safer for a ruler to be feared than loved because it is difficult to unite both qualities in one person. A ruler who is feared can be relied upon to act with prudence and humanity, without the need for the confidence that comes with being loved. This fear is not to be taken as a desire for cruelty, but as a means of being taken with the result of actions, which is a safer and more prudent way to be a ruler, especially in a state full of dangers.

5. Why does Montaigne criticize relying only on books for education?

Montaigne is against relying only on books for education as he found that it does not make one wiser or more able in judgment and virtue. He points out that such education fills the mind with knowledge but does not nourish the conscience or understanding, making the scholar a "wounded and empty man." Montaigne also sat on the "wounded and empty man of letters, and the man of letters is a man of nothing." He is also against the idea of learning as a means to an end, such as being able to speak Greek or Latin, or to write in prose, without understanding the value of wisdom and virtue. Montaigne's philosophy is that education should not only be acquired but also be utilised, and that it should not be a superficial or empty exercise but should genuinely nourish and support the soul.

6. What is the state of nature like according to Hobbes?

The state of nature, according to Hobbes, is a condition without a common power, where there is no law, and as a consequent, no justice or injustice. In this state, individuals have the liberty to use their power as they see fit for their own preservation, which Hobbes terms the Right of Nature. It is a state of war of every man against every man, where force and fraud are the cardinal virtues, and there is no propriety or dominion distinct from another's. Justice and injustice are not faculties of the body or mind in solitude, as they relate to men in society.

7. How does Descartes reach certain knowledge?

Descartes reached certain knowledge by doubting everything that could be doubly, until he found an unshakeable foundation: the existence of his own mind, as he could not doubt that he was thinking, which he then realized was the basis for his existence, as in "I think, therefore I am". He then built upon this foundation by using pure thought, especially on what is clear and distinct, rather than on sensory images or imagination, as demonstrated in the wax example where he understands the essence of the wax through intellect, not through fluctuating sensory data.

8. How does society change human nature according to Rousseau?

The text state that Rousseau's philosophy is that society changes human nature by corrupting its original state. In the state of nature, man is naturally cruel but becomes gentle with political order. Society, on the contrary, corrupts natural inclinations and makes inequality and moral inequality legitimate. In society, human faculties and the human Mind progress, but this progress is not in the original state of nature but is a change engenders by society.

Comparison Questions:

1. What is the main difference between Hobbes's and Rousseau's views of the state of nature?

Hobbes argues that in the state of nature, individuals naturally distrust and fear their fellows, and there is no justice or injustice because there is no common power or law. Rousseau, on the other hand, suggests that the state of nature is conducive to peace and that the notion of the Just and Unjust, as ascribe to Man in that state, is a product of society and not a natural condition.

2. How do Descartes and Hume differ in their views of knowledge?

In contrast to Descartes, Hume argues that knowledge is not attained by reason alone but arises entirely from experience, as we find that particular objects are constantly conjoined with each other.

Hallucination Test Questions:

1. According to The Prince, why must a ruler follow Christian monastic vows?

Machiavelli does not mention that a ruler must follow Christian monastic vows in The Prince.

2. Does Descartes prove the existence of physical bodies before proving the existence of the thinking self?

DESCARTES does not prove the existence of physical bodies before proving the existence of the thinking self. In fact, he argues that the mind (soul) is known more clearly than the body, and the essence of the mind is thinking, while the essence of the body is being extended in space. This is the basis of his well-known mind–body dualism, which comes after he has found the existence of the thinking self.

3. Does Augustine say that political and financial power makes people unable to sin?

The context does not directly state that Augustine claims political and financial power makes people unable to sin. Augustine's discussion with his question, EVODIUS, is more about the nature of free will and the ability to commit sin, not the ability to sin being directly related to political or financial power. Augustine and EVODIUS discuss the nature of virtue, justice, and the will, but there is no mention of political or financial power in this context. Therefore, the answer is that the context does not have enough information to answer the question about Augustine's view on political and financial power in the context of sin.

4. Does Hobbes consider the state of nature an ideal society without laws?

The text state that Hobbes does not consider the state of nature an ideal society without laws. In the state of nature, there is no common power, no law, and no justice or injustice, as people are driven by their passions and reason to seek peace. Hobbes distinguishes between the right of nature, which is the liberty each person has to use their power for self preservation, and the law of nature, which is a general rule discovered through reason that forbids an individual from doing anything that would end their life. Hobbes suggests that the state of nature is a state of war of every man against every man, where force and fraud are the only virtues, and justice and injustice have no place.

5. What does Socrates say about artificial intelligence?

Socrates does not discuss artificial intelligence in the provided context.